

KEY WORKS: Fanfare for the Common Man, 1942; Appalachian Spring, 1944; Clarinet Concerto, 1948; The Tender Land (opera), 1954

Aram Khachaturian

1903–1978, ARMENIAN

Although his parents were Armenian, Khachaturian was born in Georgia, spent most of his life in Moscow, and throughout his career was regarded as a Soviet composer (Armenia was part of the Soviet Union from 1922 to 1991). Nevertheless, his music was strongly influenced by Armenian folk traditions and he is now generally considered to be one of the country's leading cultural heroes. With his great contemporaries Prokofiev and Shostakovich, he was officially censured in 1948 for showing “decadent” Western influence in his work, but generally he managed to negotiate the strictures of the Soviet regime. Over the years he received many official honors in the USSR as well as international recognition. Khachaturian's diverse output includes symphonies, concertos, instrumental, chamber, and vocal music, and numerous film scores. His most famous works are probably his ballets Gayane (which includes the famous “Sabre Dance”) and Spartacus, which reveal his